and nutraceutical compounds. Examples: Geraniums (*Pelargonium*), Busy lizzies (*Impatiens*), *Chrysanthemum* and *Petunia*.



Figure 23.5 Flower Farming

INFO BIT

Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)

It is an agricultural crops insurance scheme of Indian government. Under this scheme the central government provides insurance cover and financial assistance to farmers. It was launched on 18th February 2016.

Uses of flowers

1. Flowers are used for decoration purpose.
2. They are also used for personal needs and, religious and ceremonial offerings.
3. They impart colour and beauty to the garden.
4. They increase country's economy.

23.1.4 Landscape Gardening

Landscape horticulture is the study of designing and constructing landscapes in homes, business firms and public areas to imitate natural scenery



Figure 23.6 Landscape gardening

23.2 Manuring (Biomanuring)

Organic manures are predominantly derived from plant debris, animal faeces and microbes. They make the soil fertile by adding nutrients like nitrogen. Few of them are listed below.

23.2.1 Animal Manure

It consists of faeces and urine from livestocks like cattle, horses, pigs, sheep, chickens, turkeys, rabbits, etc. Manures from different animals have different qualities and different applications.

Farmyard manure: It is a mixture of cattle dung, urine, litter material and other dairy wastes. On an average well decomposed farm yard manure contains 0.5% Nitrogen, 0.2% available phosphate and 0.5% available potash.

Sheep and Goat manure : It contains higher nutrients than farm yard manure. It contains 3% Nitrogen, 1% phosphorus pentoxide and 2% potassium oxide.

23.2.2 Compost

Compost is a soil conditioner as well as a fertilizer, that is rich in nutrients. It is produced by natural decomposition of organic matter such as crop residues, animal wastes, food wastes, industrial and municipal wastes by microorganisms under controlled conditions.

23.2.3 Green Manure

Green manure is obtained by collection and decomposition of green leaves, twigs of trees, field bunds etc. Green manure improves soil structure, increases water holding capacity and decreases soil loss by erosion. It also helps in reclamation of alkaline soils and reduces weed proliferation. It is a manure obtained from undecomposed green material derived from leguminous plants e.g. Sunhemp (*Crotolaria juncea*), Dhaincha (*Sesbania aculeata*), Sesbania (*Sesbania speciosa*).

23.3 Biofertilizers

Biofertilizers are substances that contain living microorganisms which, when applied

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